



CRASHDAY

Rating: 7/10

Minimum System Requirements: Pentium 4 1.5 GHz,
512 MB RAM, 64 MB Graphics Card

Publisher: Atari

Developer: Moon Byte Studios

with them, so while you're floundering about trying to discern your Londons from your Tokyos, someone has already come upon you from nowhere and turned you into scrap metal, or stolen your flag, or passed you the bomb—as the case may be.

The Career Mode is just a pathetic excuse to get you to play all the game modes—there's even a voice narrative before each mission to fool you into believing there's an actual story, but it takes a lot more than that awful German/American accented voice to convince you.

However, the Mini Games, notably the Long Jumps and Blast Jumps (jump the farthest you can before your car blows up), are tremendous fun, especially if you're competing with someone for the longest distance record.

Party!

To turn around all the gripes with Crashday's single player mode, you'll need to switch to multiplayer. Human stupidity is *much* more entertaining than artificial intelligence—your opponents are faced with the same difficulties as you are, so the chances of your winning an event are more realistic. The Wrecking Match is the most fun here—especially for venting frustrations, caused mainly due to losing pathetically in Mini Games, on bald-headed colleagues (see *Digit Diary*)—we were playing it in the office till 1 AM two days in a row!

You will now notice that *all* the game modes that Crashday offers are geared more towards insanely fun LAN parties and online play than the single player. It

supports up to eight players per event—quite respectable, and more than you'll probably ever need for a good blow-up session anyway.

Pretty

Moon Byte Studios' attention to the multiplayer mode is also apparent in the graphics of the game—they're quite impressive, but still remain light enough to run on most half-decent graphics cards. The damage modelling is also quite well done, making all the crashes, booms and bangs very entertaining.

Every time you use the nitro boost when driving, the camera changes to wide-angle mode, and comes back to normal mode when you release it—giving the experience a weird rubber-band feel.

Insecta

Fun though it is, *Crashday* is still quite buggy—it would randomly crash on our ATI cards, but seemed to be happier on NVIDIA's. It's also riddled with graphics bugs: there were numerous instances where the cars would go straight into the ground—with two wheels *below* the ground surface, I mean. It gets even more bizarre in online play—I've even seen cars moving around the map with only their roofs showing over the ground.

Overall, unless you get addicted to breaking Mini Game records like some of us here have, you're not going to get much out of the game if you don't intend to play it online or over a LAN. But once you *do* get into multiplayer, it's hard to get out.

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